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AFP

MASSIVE EARTHQUAKE IN RUSSIA TRIGGERS TSUNAMI ALERTS

The devastation is visible in the tsunami-hit Severo-Kurilsk on Paramushir island of Russia's northern Kuril Islands. One of the strongest earthquakes ever recorded at 8.8 struck Russia's sparsely populated Far East early yesterday, causing tsunamis of up to four metres (12 feet) across the Pacific and sparking evacuations from Hawaii to Japan. Several people were injured in Russia by the quake. **SEE ALSO P9**

UAE's non-oil foreign trade grows by 24%

FIRST-HALF TRADE HITS DH1.7 TRILLION, DOUBLE THE MARK OF FIVE YEARS AGO

DUBAI

BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

The UAE's non-oil foreign trade grew by 24 per cent in the first half of this year, reaching Dh1.7 trillion — a milestone that underscores the country's rapid economic expansion.

His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, announced the figures on his official X account, highlighting that the UAE's performance far outpaced global trade growth, which averaged just 1.75 per cent over the same period.

"Our non-oil foreign trade reached Dh1.7 trillion in the first six months, double the figures from only five years ago," Shaikh Mohammad said. "Trade with our partners has soared to record levels: up 120 per cent along with Switzerland, 33 per cent with India, 41 per cent with Turkey, 29 per cent with the US, and 15 per cent with China."

1.75%
average growth in global trade in the first half of 2025

44.7%
growth in UAE's non-oil exports to Dh369.5 billion

Unprecedented growth

"These figures reflect the strength of our global economic partnerships and the unprecedented growth of the UAE, under the leadership of my brother, Mohammad Bin Zayed," he added. "They are also a promise that the future will be even more beautiful and greater."

The UAE's non-oil foreign trade recorded an increase of 37.8 per cent and 59.5 per cent in the first half of 2025 compared to the same period in 2023 and 2022, respectively. Trade output is double the figure achieved in the first half of 2021 and more than double the figure recorded in the first half of 2019.

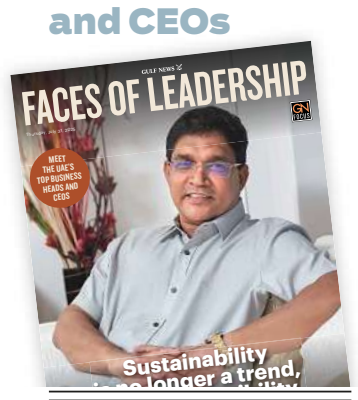
The UAE's non-oil exports reached Dh369.5 billion during the first half of 2025, with a growth rate of more than 44.7 per cent — for the first time in the country's history — as well as a growth rate of 80 per cent when compared to the first half of 2023. This level is more than double the value of non-oil exports during 2022, more than double 2021's level and 3 times larger than in 2020 and 2019. Non-oil exports increased during the first half of 2025 at a record rate of 210.3 per cent compared to the same period in 2019.

The UAE's imports of non-oil goods amounted to Dh969.3 billion during the first half of 2025, a growth rate of 22.5 per cent compared to the same period in 2024. *— with inputs from WAM*

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US to impose 25% tariffs on India; rupee drops to 23.8 against dirham

India and US had been working on a trade deal ahead of August 1 deadline

DUBAI

BY MANOJ NAIR
Business Editor

President Donald Trump yesterday said that he'll impose a 25 per cent tariff on goods from India, plus an additional import tax because of India's purchasing of Russian oil.

Trump said on his Truth Social platform that India "is our friend" but its "Tariffs are far too high" on US goods.

The Republican president added that India buys military equipment and oil from Russia, which he said has enabled the war in Ukraine. As a result, he intends to charge an additional "penalty" starting tomorrow as part of the launch of his administration's revised tariffs on multiple countries.

The Census Bureau reported that the US ran a $45.8 billion trade imbalance in goods with India last year, meaning it imported more than it exported.

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As a direct fallout, currency traders in the UAE believe there could be a strong chance for the rupee to fall all the way to 24 against dirham for the first time. The lowest ever point for the rupee against dirham was 23.94 early February.

Rupee under pressure

The Indian rupee has been under tremendous pressure over the last 3 days, and had dropped all the way past 23.8 levels against the dirham.

This is the lowest level the rupee has been since March. (For UAE's Indian expats, this opens up one of the best dirham-rupee exchange levels this year.)

"The imposition of 25 per cent US tariffs from August 1 is likely to affect trade flows across key sectors such as engineering goods, pharma and IT services," said Krishnan Ramachandran, CEO of Barjeel Geojit Financial Services.

"In the near term, exporters may face margin pressure — and increased policy uncertainty. While the overall macro-economic impact may be contained, prolonged tariffs could alter supply chain dynamics and prompt a strategic shift, wherever possible, towards diversified export markets."

The latest US announcement comes after the Indian stock and currency markets closed for the day. "If the 25 per cent had been announced earlier in the day, there would have been a bloodbath," said a stock trader. "Thankfully, Trump didn't do that."

— with inputs from agencies



SPORT
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EU's Entry/Exit System to launch on October 12

It will digitally record entries and exits of non-EU nationals travelling to 29 nations

BRUSSELS

The European Commission has set October 12 this year as the launch date for the progressive start of operations of the EU's Entry/Exit System (EES).

The EES is an advanced technological system that will digitally record the entries and exits of non-EU nationals travelling to 29 European countries, including Schengen Associated ones, for short stays. It will capture biometric data, such as fingerprints, facial image, and other travel information, gradually replacing the current system of passport stamping.

The EES will modernise and improve the management of EU external borders. It will provide reliable data on border crossings, systematically detect overstayers as well as cases of document and identity fraud. The EES will thus contribute to preventing irregular migration and protecting the security of European citizens. Additionally, with the increased use of automated border checks, travelling will become smoother and safer for all.

Data to be protected

The new system meets the highest standards of data and privacy protection, ensuring that travellers' personal data remain protected and secure.

From October 12 onwards, Member States will start introducing the EES gradually over a period of six months. Border authorities will progressively register the data of third country nationals crossing the borders. At the end of this period, the EES will be fully deployed at all border crossing points. *— WAM*

